

موضوع: موقعیت و چشم انداز علم و فناوری در نیجریه و ایران

Position and Prospects of Science and Technology in Nigeria and Iran

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Abstract

In an effort to make science and technology the fulcrum of its development, Nigeria made the study of Basic Science compulsory for all students for the first 9 years in school. Specialized schools, science colleges and vocational colleges were established. The country has 158 universities, 26 monotechnics and 113 polytechnics as at 2017. Each of these has scientific findings, innovations and inventions which are lying idle due to non-publicity, non-recognition, non-commercialisation and perceived inferiority compared to foreign technologies. In addition, there exists a Federal Ministry of Science and Technology. It has 17 agencies under its supervision with specialization in biotechnology, space science, technology incubation among others. Yet their contribution to national development is nothing to write home about. The major problem is lack of funds. Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) also contribute their quota through training and capacity building to develop internet-based entrepreneurs (netpreneurs). These NGOs attract international collaboration and funding because they can easily align their objectives with those of donor agencies compared to government owned institutions. On the other hand, the sanction imposed on Iran prompted it to take giant strides in building science and technology experts and institutions. This is evident from the curriculum of primary and middle schools as well as the establishment of 1133 universities as at 2015. Also, the National Masterplan for Science and Education, National Policy for Science and Technology, Law supporting Knowledge-Based Firms are some initiatives of the government to make science and technology the driving force of its development. Creation of science and technology parks which host Knowledge-Based Small and Medium Scale Enterprises help in employing thousands of Iranians and generating billions of dollars in revenue. In both countries, opportunities exist in modernizing indigenous knowledge, developing local technologies to make them internationally acceptable as well as commercializing research findings, inventions and innovations.